

POSSESSIVE CASE (Genitive Case)

Prof. Tommy Cherian

8547006780

POSSESSIVE CASE

(Genitive Case)

1. **s-Genitive** – mostly for people and animals

- John's bike
- the cat's basket

2. ***of*-phrase** – mostly for things

- the name **of** the school
- the top floor **of** the building

POSSESSIVE CASE (Genitive Case)

Don't use 's after things.

I clean the ~~garden's pond~~ every week.

I clean the pond in the garden every week.

What's the ~~book's name~~?

What's the name of the book?

POSSESSIVE CASE (Genitive Case)

If things have a connection to people we also use the *s-genitive (possessive)*.

- Germany's economy = the economy **of** Germany

POSSESSIVE CASE (Genitive Case)

You can sometimes use 's after countries and cities.

India's population is rising.

But you cannot do this if it refers to a person.

~~I met London's mayor last week.~~

I met the mayor of London last week.

~~England's Queen is well-known.~~

The Queen of England is well-known.

POSSESSIVE CASE (Genitive Case)

You can usually use 's after organisations and groups of people.

It's the government's decision.

OR

It's the decision of the government

Tom is the company's new director.

OR

Tom is the new director of the company.

POSSESSIVE CASE

(Genitive Case)

If things have a connection to people we also use the *s-genitive (possessive)*.

- Germany's economy = the economy **of** Germany

In time expressions we also use the *s-genitive (possessive)*.

- a three weeks' holiday
- (a three week holiday)

Possessive Case – 's

The possessive case shows ownership.

With the addition of 's (or sometimes just the apostrophe), a noun can change from a simple person, place, or thing to a person, place, or thing that **owns something**. There are a few different ways to form the possessive of a noun.

POSSESSIVE CASE

If the **noun doesn't end with an s,**
add 's to the end of the noun.

- *This is Mary and her dog. The dog is **Mary's** pet; Mary is not the **dog's** pet.*
- *This thick curtain is capable of shutting out the summer **sun's** heat and light.*
- *This thick curtain is capable of shutting out heat and light **of** the summer **sun**.*

POSSESSIVE CASE

If the plural noun ends with an **s**,
add ' after the **s**.

- *This is the way to the **boys'** room.*
- *She got a job in the **teachers'** section of the library.*

POSSESSIVE CASE

If the plural noun doesn't end with an **s**, add **'s** to the end of the noun.

- *This is the way to the **men's** room.*
- *She got a job in the **children's** section of the library.*

POSSESSIVE CASE

Do we add **another s** for the possessive form of a **name ending with s**?

Which is correct? **Chris's car or Chris' car?**
James's hat or James' hat?

Actually, both ways are correct.

If a proper name ends with an **s**, you can add just the apostrophe OR an apostrophe and an **s**.

POSSESSIVE CASE

- *You're sitting in Chris' chair.*
- *You're sitting in Chris's chair.*
- *Have you seen James' car?*
- *Have you seen James's car?*
- *Where is Jess' book bag?*
- *Where is Jess's book bag?*
- *I'm in Ms. Jones' class this year.*
- *I'm in Ms. Jones's class this year.*

POSSESSIVE CASE

- But when you have a *plural* noun that ends in **s**, add just the apostrophe.
- This is also true when you have a proper noun that's plural.

POSSESSIVE CASE

- *This is the **boys'** bedroom.*
- *My **parents'** house is a lovely old one.*
- *The **scissors'** handles just snapped off.*
- *The **Jeffersons'** yard is always beautifully landscaped.*

POSSESSIVE CASE

Should you write *student's* or *students'*?

- The *student's* favourite subject was science. (single student)
- The *students'* favourite subject was science. (many students)

POSSESSIVE CASE

If you have a compound noun (for example, when you're talking about two people who jointly own one thing), **change only the last noun** to the possessive.

POSSESSIVE CASE

- *John and Sita's new apartment is really neat.*
- *Please tell Annie and Mary's mother that they'll be late getting home from school. (They are siblings)*
- *Please tell Annie's and Mary's mothers that they'll be late getting home from school.*

POSSESSIVE CASE

- If the possessor is a building, an object, or a piece of furniture, you don't need to add an apostrophe to show possession.

POSSESSIVE CASE

- *The maid cleaned the hotel's room. X*
- *The maid cleaned the hotel room.*
- *We met in the office's lobby. X*
- *We met in the office lobby.*
- *Shut the car's door. X*
- *Shut the car door.*

POSSESSIVE CASE

- *There are also **some fixed expressions** where the possessive form is used.*

POSSESSIVE CASE

Examples with time

- *a day's work*
- *a month's pay*
- *today's newspaper*
- *in a year's time*
- *a three weeks' holiday*
- *(a three week holiday)*

POSSESSIVE CASE

Other examples

For God's sake! (= exclamation of exasperation)

A stone's throw away (= very near)

At death's door (= very ill)

In my mind's eye (= in my imagination)

POSSESSIVE CASE

The possessive is also used to refer to shops, restaurants, churches and colleges, using the name or job title of the owner.

Shall we go to Luigi's for lunch?

I've got an appointment at the dentist's at eleven o'clock.

Is Saint Mary's an all-girls school?

